Sometimes we do not know which fields users want to search; they may want a query to focus on the `title` field, the `synopsis` or `tags` field, or all of them. In the next section, we go over ways to specify fields.

10.9.1 Fields in a query_string query

In a typical search box, the user does not need to specify a field when searching for something. For example, take a look at the following query.

Listing 10.21 Query string with no fields specified

```
GET books/_search
{
  "query": {
    "query_string": {
      "query": "Patterns"
    }
  },
  "highlight": {
    "fields": {
      "title": {},
      "synopsis": {},
      "tags": {}
    }
  }
}
```

The query search word (fields are not mentioned)

Highlights responses

We want to search for the keyword "Patterns" in the previous query. Remember, the query does not ask us to search any fields. It is a generic query that should be executed across all fields. The response shows that some results are highlighted on a different field for individual documents:

```
"highlight" : {
   "synopsis" : ["Head First Design <em>Patterns</em> is one of ..."],
     "title" : ["Head First Design <em>Patterns</em>"]
},
...
"highlight" : {
 "synopsis" : [ "create .. using modern application <em>patterns</em>"]
},
...
```

Instead of letting the engine search query against all available fields, we can assist Elasticsearch by providing fields to run the search on. The next listing shows how to do this.

Listing 10.22 Specifying fields explicitly in a `query_string` query

```
GET books/_search
{
  "query": {
    "query_string": {
      "query": "Patterns",
```

The query criterion with no fields mentioned